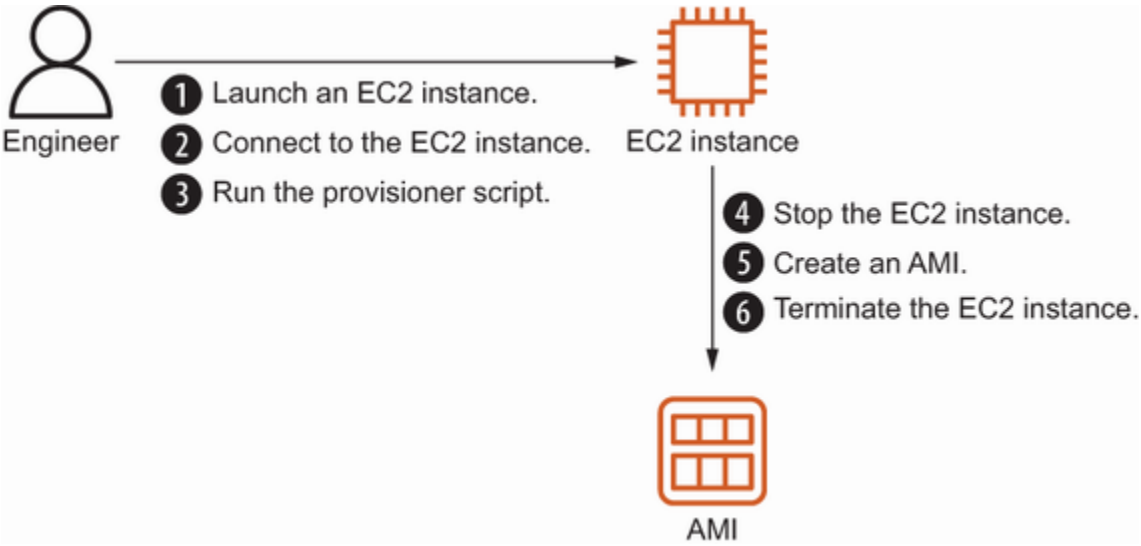


Figure 15.4 Packer automates the process of creating AMIs.

To use Packer, you need to define a template. You'll find the Packer template to build an AMI for Etherpad at chapter15/etherpad.pkr.hcl in the book's code repository on GitHub at https://github.com/AWSinAction/code3. The template starts with configuring Packer and the required plugins, as shown next.

Listing 15.6 The Packer template to build an Etherpad AMI, part 1

```
packer {
  required_plugins {
    amazon = {
      version = ">= 0.0.2"
      source  = "github.com/hashicorp/amazon"
    }
  }
}
```

Next, you need to define a source AMI as well as the details for the EC2 instance, which Packer will launch to build the AMI. By default,